



You will both be encouraged to touch, stroke, and caress your small baby, and to spend as much time as possible talking and singing to him.

Your baby's care

While your baby is in the NICU, they may be treated with medication have various tests and checkups. In some cases, they will need to be on a ventilator.

Tests and X-rays Your baby may have blood tests to check for infection and anemia; to check kidney function, oxygen, carbon dioxide, and sugar levels, and to identify her blood group. The frequency of these depends on how ill or premature you baby is. In neonatal intensive care, babies need blood tests periodically. Some babies need an X-ray while they're there, and very premature babies often need many chest X-rays and sometimes abdominal ones.

Assisting your baby Some babies need a little extra oxygen, while others need constant oxygen through a nasal tube. For very premature babies, a tube may be placed into the trachea (windpipe) and connected to a ventilator that blows oxygen into the lungs. Babies are monitored to see when they can be weaned off the ventilator.

Most babies in intensive care need one or more IVs to give fluids, blood, and antibiotics. Very small babies may be fed through a long, fine feeding tube running through the mouth or nose to the stomach. They may also need at least one blood transfusion, for some cases of conditions like anemia and jaundice.

Antibiotics are often given to prevent infection. Some babies need medicine to keep their blood pressure up, and many who are ventilated need medicine to sedate them